VGGNet Shows the Power of a Simple Idea

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE · MACHINE LEARNING · DEEP LEARNING

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Sometimes, an architecture becomes influential because its design is easy to understand.

VGGNet is a great example.

Its central idea was straightforward: build deeper networks using repeated small 3x3 convolution filters.

Instead of relying on many different convolution sizes, VGG stacked small convolutions to build increasingly complex visual features.

Why use small filters?

Stacking multiple 3x3 convolutions can increase the effective receptive field while introducing additional nonlinearities between layers.

That gives the network more opportunities to learn complex representations.

But VGG also demonstrates an important engineering trade-off.

Its large fully connected layers and substantial parameter count make it computationally expensive compared with many later architectures.

So, should you still learn VGGNet?

Absolutely.

It provides a useful baseline for understanding convolutional feature hierarchies and the evolution of CNN architectures.

You don't need to deploy every influential architecture.

But understanding why it worked, and where it became inefficient, helps you make better choices today.

#VGGNet #CNN #ComputerVision

Thanks for reading.

Follow **Yasir Usman** for more on AI, ML and computer vision.

Code: github.com/yasirusman85/Tank